

D402

Community and Public Health

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A pediatric clinic in a city of 400,000 notices that asthma visits cluster among children in older apartment buildings with mold and pests. The clinic recently hired a new medical director. Which factor is the main driver named here?

- A. Poor leadership at the clinic.
- B. Lack of medical care.
- C. Individual choice about taking medication.
- D. Neighborhood and built environment (housing quality).

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A health department wants to improve health through the “economic stability” domain. Which program fits?

- A. A job training and earned income tax credit sign-up program.
- B. A new park with walking trails.
- C. A new hospital cardiac unit.
- D. A high school graduation initiative.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A 45-year-old woman in a rural county has Medicaid coverage but has missed three specialist appointments. The nearest specialist is 70 miles away and she does not own a car. Her county has a new library. What is the main barrier?

- A. Accessibility — transportation and distance.
- B. Affordability, because she lacks insurance.
- C. None; having insurance means she has access.
- D. Acceptability — she distrusts specialists.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A county health department reviews death records and hospital data to track rising overdose deaths by zip code. The department is housed in a historic courthouse. Which core function is this?

- A. Assurance
- B. Policy development
- C. Assessment
- D. Individual patient treatment

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A health department inspects restaurants and licenses clinics to make sure services meet standards. Which core function is this?

- A. Policy development
- B. Assurance
- C. Research only
- D. Assessment

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A city gives every neighborhood the same \$50,000 for fresh produce programs. One neighborhood has three grocery stores; another has none and higher diabetes rates. A council member who owns a bakery backed the plan. What would an equity approach do?

- A. Keep equal funding, since equal is always fair.
- B. Let the bakery owner decide.
- C. Give more to the neighborhood with three stores.
- D. Direct more resources to the neighborhood with no grocery stores and higher need.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which example shows equality rather than equity?

- A. Translation services are added where many families speak other languages.
- B. Free bus passes go to families without cars.
- C. Every school gets the same number of nurses regardless of enrollment or student needs.
- D. Schools with more students with asthma get extra nursing hours.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A health system struggles to enroll Spanish-speaking farmworker families in prenatal care. The system has a large marketing budget and a new logo. What is the most effective step?

- A. Have community health workers diagnose conditions at home.
- B. Translate forms only.
- C. Run billboards featuring the new logo.
- D. Hire community health workers from the farmworker community for outreach and navigation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A school teaches students about nutrition, but obesity rates do not change. The school vending machines sell sugary drinks, and the district is rated highly for test scores. Using the socio-ecological model, what is missing?

- A. Nothing; education always changes behavior.
- B. Change at the organizational level, such as healthier vending choices.
- C. More nutrition lessons.
- D. Higher test scores.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A state passes a tax on sugary drinks. At which socio-ecological level is this?

- A. Individual
- B. Policy
- C. Interpersonal
- D. Organizational

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A county has high rates of lead poisoning in children. A local hospital with a nationally ranked pediatrics team proposes more testing and treatment. Which is the upstream response?

- A. Remove lead paint and pipes from older homes.
- B. Expand the pediatrics team.
- C. Treat more children with chelation therapy.
- D. Test all children yearly.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An uninsured cook who earns \$22,000 a year needs a primary care doctor. There is a Federally Qualified Health Center near her home and a private practice across town with a great website. What can she expect at the FQHC?

- A.** All care will be completely free.
- B.** She should go to the private practice for better care.
- C.** She will be seen and charged on a sliding scale based on her income.
- D.** She will be turned away without insurance.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A pediatric clinic in a city of 400,000 notices that asthma visits cluster among children in older apartment buildings with mold and pests. ~~The clinic recently hired a new medical director.~~ Which factor is the main driver named here?

Target word: determinant category **Decides:** Housing conditions.

A	Camouflage	The new director is unrelated.
B	Adjacent category	They are getting clinic visits; the driver is housing.
C	Inverted operation	Shifts the cause from conditions to behavior.
D	Correct	Mold and pests in housing are social determinants.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A health department wants to improve health through the “economic stability” domain. Which program fits?

Target word: reverse: from domain to program **Decides:** Income and employment supports.

A	Correct	Addresses income and employment.
B	Confusion set	Built environment.
C	Inverted operation	Downstream healthcare, not economic stability.
D	Adjacent category	Education access.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A 45-year-old woman in a rural county has Medicaid coverage but has missed three specialist appointments. The nearest specialist is 70 miles away and she does not own a car. ~~Her county has a new library.~~ What is the main barrier?

Target word: type of barrier **Decides:** Distance without transportation.

A	Correct	She is insured but cannot reach care.
B	Wrong stem number	She has Medicaid.
C	Absolute language	Coverage does not guarantee access.
D	Confusion set	Nothing in the stem suggests distrust.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A county health department reviews death records and hospital data to track rising overdose deaths by zip code. ~~The department is housed in a historic courthouse.~~ Which core function is this?

Target word: classify activity **Decides:** Monitoring and diagnosing community health.

A	Adjacent category	Making sure services exist.
B	Confusion set	Would be using data to shape policy.
C	Correct	Collecting and analyzing data on community health.
D	Inverted operation	Public health focuses on populations.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A health department inspects restaurants and licenses clinics to make sure services meet standards. Which core function is this?

Target word: reverse: from activity to function **Decides:** Ensuring services.

A	Confusion set	Setting policy.
B	Correct	Making sure required services exist and meet standards.
C	Adjacent category	Not one of the three core functions.
D	Confusion set	Monitoring health data.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A city gives every neighborhood the same \$50,000 for fresh produce programs. One neighborhood has three grocery stores; another has none and higher diabetes rates. ~~A council member who owns a bakery backed the plan.~~ What would an equity approach do?

Target word: equity vs. equality **Decides:** Different needs.

A	Absolute language	Equal is not equitable when needs differ.
B	Camouflage	His business is irrelevant.
C	Inverted operation	Reverses need.
D	Correct	Equity allocates by need.

7. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

Which example shows equality rather than equity?

Target word: reverse: pick the equality example **Decides:** Same resources regardless of need.

A	Confusion set	Also equity.
B	Adjacent category	Need-based — equity.
C	Correct	Identical allocation.
D	Inverted operation	That is equity.

8. Answer D Concept 5

A health system struggles to enroll Spanish-speaking farmworker families in prenatal care. ~~The system has a large marketing budget and a new logo.~~ What is the most effective step?

Target word: best strategy **Decides:** Distrust and language barriers.

A	Adjacent category	Outside their role.
B	Dropped element	Translation helps but leaves out trust and navigation.
C	Camouflage	Marketing does not build trust.
D	Correct	Trusted liaisons bridge the gap.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A school teaches students about nutrition, but obesity rates do not change. The school vending machines sell sugary drinks, and ~~the district is rated highly for test scores.~~ Using the socio-ecological model, what is missing?

Target word: level to add **Decides:** Only the individual level was targeted.

A	Absolute language	Knowledge alone rarely changes behavior.
B	Correct	Behavior change needs support beyond the individual.
C	Dropped element	Repeats the individual level.
D	Camouflage	Unrelated to the model.

10. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

A state passes a tax on sugary drinks. At which socio-ecological level is this?

Target word: reverse: classify **Decides:** Laws and regulations.

A	Inverted operation	Targets knowledge and attitudes.
B	Correct	Laws are at the policy level.
C	Confusion set	Family and peers.
D	Adjacent category	Workplaces and schools.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A county has high rates of lead poisoning in children. A local hospital ~~with a nationally ranked pediatrics team~~ proposes more testing and treatment. Which is the upstream response?

Target word: upstream vs. downstream **Decides:** Remove the source.

A	Correct	Changes the conditions causing exposure.
B	Camouflage	The team's rank does not make its response upstream.
C	Inverted operation	Downstream treatment after exposure.
D	Adjacent category	Detection is still downstream of exposure.

12. Answer C Concept 8

An uninsured cook who earns \$22,000 a year needs a primary care doctor. There is a Federally Qualified Health Center near her home and ~~a private practice across town with a great website.~~ What can she expect at the FQHC?

Target word: FQHC rules **Decides:** Must serve regardless of ability to pay.

A	Absolute language	Sliding scale, not always free.
B	Camouflage	The website does not decide.
C	Correct	FQHCs must serve everyone.
D	Inverted operation	FQHCs cannot refuse for inability to pay.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Social determinants of health	Conditions where people live, learn, work, and play — economic stability, education, healthcare access, neighborhood and built environment, and social and community context — shape health more than clinical care alone.	Assuming health outcomes are mostly the result of personal choices or medical care.	A health problem linked to housing, income, transportation, food, or schooling.
2	Barriers to healthcare access	Access fails when care is unavailable, unaffordable, physically hard to reach, or culturally or linguistically unacceptable; fix the barrier that is actually present.	Assuming insurance alone guarantees access.	An insured person who still does not get care.
3	Core functions of public health	Assessment (monitoring and diagnosing community health), policy development (informing and setting health policy), and assurance (making sure services and a competent workforce exist).	Thinking public health is mainly about treating individual patients.	A health department activity to classify.
4	Equity vs. equality	Equality gives everyone the same resources; equity gives resources according to need so everyone has a fair chance at good health.	Believing identical resources for all groups is always the fairest approach.	Groups starting from different places with different needs.
5	Community health workers	Community health workers are trusted members of the community who bridge residents and services through outreach, education, navigation, and advocacy.	Treating them as clinicians who diagnose or as simple translators.	Distrust or language barriers between a community and the health system.
6	Socio-ecological model	Health behavior is shaped at individual, interpersonal, organizational, community, and policy levels; lasting change usually works at more than one level.	Aiming every program only at individual knowledge.	An intervention to classify by level or a program that fails despite good education.
7	Upstream vs. downstream	Upstream actions change the conditions that cause poor health (policy, housing, food access); downstream actions treat people after they are sick.	Calling better treatment of a disease an upstream fix.	A choice between treating cases and changing root causes.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Safety-net providers	Federally Qualified Health Centers serve underserved areas and must see patients regardless of ability to pay, using a sliding fee scale based on income.	Thinking FQHCs are free clinics only for the uninsured or that they can turn away patients who cannot pay.	An uninsured or low-income patient looking for primary care.

Course scope (public description): Community and Public Health provides learners with an understanding of the benefits community health offers individuals and families. The course also will identify barriers that will impact health and healthcare access, leading to improved community health. There are no prerequisites for this course.